

Nine Universities, Compared in Detail

Every course, date, hour and euro at the nine Spanish universities on your shortlist — and which of them will sell you enough consecutive teaching to pass 180 days.

THE TEST EVERYTHING IS MEASURED AGAINST

Your permit lasts **the course, plus up to 45 days**. If the total **exceeds 180 days** you get a TIE and a real residence. Below it, a visa sticker and a flight home.

Art. 55.2 — "La vigencia de la autorización **deberá** comenzar con una antelación de un mes con respecto al comienzo de la actividad o estudios..." · "La vigencia **se extenderá** quince días más allá de la finalización de la actividad o estudios."

"The validity of the authorisation **shall** begin one month in advance of the start of the activity or studies..." · "The validity **shall extend** fifteen days beyond the end of the activity or studies." — *deberá* and *se extenderá*: shall, not may.

THE 45 DAYS IS MANDATORY BY DEFAULT – THE OPTION TO WAIVE IT IS YOURS

Instrucción TERCERA.1 calls the periods "*optativos*", but read what follows: "*la persona extranjera **podrá optar, siempre y cuando así lo solicite expresamente**, porque se le otorgue una autorización por una duración igual a la de la actividad o estudios... **sin** otorgarle una vigencia adicional*" — "the foreign national **may choose, provided they expressly request it**, to be granted an authorisation equal to the duration of the studies, **without** the additional validity."

The applicant may **opt out**. The officer cannot simply withhold it. **Never waive it.**

ONE QUALIFICATION ON THE MONTH

Art. 55.2 adds an exception: if you file **within two months** of the start, the authorisation may instead run from the decision date. So the month before is guaranteed only when you file **more than two months ahead**. **The fifteen days after has no exception at all.**

The answer, up front

UNIVERSITY	LONGEST SINGLE ENROLMENT FROM Q1 2027	COURSE DAYS	COST	OVER 180 WITH THE PADDING?
Cáceres — IELE	11 Jan → 17 Dec 2027, one product	341	2.500	✓ yes
León	7 Jan → 21 Dec 2027, stacked on one form	349	5.725	✓ yes
Zaragoza	11 Jan → 7 Jul 2027, stacked	178	2.185	✓ on the 15 days alone
La Rioja	11 Jan → 16 Jun 2027	157	2.725	✓ 202 with the month
Santiago — USC	7 Jan → ~2 Jun 2027 (21 wks)	~147	2.921	✓ 192 with the month
Oviedo	11 Jan → 14 May 2027	124	1.625	✗ 169 even padded
Murcia	Feb → May 2027	~120	1.575	✗ 165 even padded
Burgos	18 Jan → 1 Feb 2027 (intensive only)	15	150	✗
Almería	nothing published — no spring or summer courses	—	—	✗

THREE OF THE NINE KEEP YOUR MONEY IF THE VISA IS REFUSED

Almería — *"No se considerará causa justificada... la denegación del visado"* — "Visa refusal shall not be considered justified cause."

Murcia — *"no se devolverá el importe pagado... aunque se trate de una causa de fuerza mayor"* — "the amount paid will not be refunded, even in a case of force majeure."

Oviedo — refunds only where the university cancels; a visa refusal is attributable to you.

IELE — Universidad de Extremadura, Cáceres

341 days in a single product for €2,500. The only full academic year in Spain that starts in January.

ADDRESS	Avda. Virgen de la Montaña 14, 10002 Cáceres
EMAIL	seciele@unex.es (secretariat) · diriele@unex.es (director) · profiele@unex.es (deferrals) · contafuex@unex.es (invoices)
PHONE	Not published anywhere on the site — worth noting for a visa file
RUN BY	UEX institute; finances by Fundación Universidad-Sociedad de la UEx, CIF G06456487
ACCREDITED	Instituto Cervantes · DELE and CCSE exam centre

Courses and prices

COURSE	H/WK	2027 INTAKE	PRICE
Intensive Spanish Program	20	11 Jan → 17 Dec 2027	2.500
Master's Pathway — year 1	20	11 Jan 2027	2.500
Master's Pathway — year 2 (the master's)	—	—	860 — 5.000
Vocational Pathway — year 1	20	11 Jan 2027	2.500
Bachelor's Pathway	20 +6 PCE	Jan 2027	4.500
Spanish for Healthcare Professionals	20	11 Jan 2027	4.500
One-Month Course (beginners only)	20	11 Jan → 8 Feb 2027	500

Timetable **16:00–20:00, Monday to Friday** — afternoons, which leaves mornings free for work. Levels A1 → B2 (C1 exists in the teaching plan). Absolute beginners accepted on both intakes: *"No special requirements are needed to enroll."* Class size minimum 5, maximum 20. Coursebook ~€30 extra. Total programme hours: not published.

THE JANUARY DATE IS SETTLED: 11 JANUARY 2027

Their site carries two answers. The **Intensive Spanish Program** page says **18 January**; the **FAQ, the May 2026 brochure, the August 2026 healthcare brochure and the One-Month Course** page all say **11 January**. Four sources to one, and the most recently dated asset is among the four. **11 January is current; the 18 January line is stale.**

BUT THE CHECKOUT CONTAINS NO DATES AT ALL

IELE's booking system is a flat list of tickets — programme name, price, nothing else. **No date picker, no term selector, no intake selector.** Dates are settled by email afterwards: their FAQ asks the student to supply *"the course start and end dates"* when requesting the admission letter.

That is administratively loose for a visa file, and it is exactly why the site can carry two January dates without the booking system contradicting either. **Get the dates in writing before you pay.**

Payment

Two instalments of **€1,250**, sold as separate tickets — one before the course starts, one in the third month. Card or transfer to Santander, IBAN ES64 0049 6147 62 2310004962, beneficiary Fundación Universidad Sociedad de la UEx. Registration closes one month before the start. No separate enrolment fee.

Visa documents — the most complete of the nine

- **Offer Letter** — before payment, on request by email
- **Letter of Admission** — after enrolment; send passport copy and proof of payment
- Invoice or receipt via contafuex@unex.es
- **Free deferral if the visa is slow:** "you may postpone the start of your course to a later edition without any inconvenience"

"If a student's study visa application is refused... the student may request a refund by submitting an official copy of the visa refusal letter... within seven (7) calendar days... A **€150 administrative fee**, together with any bank charges, will be deducted."

Refund minus €150. Claim within 7 days of the refusal; processed within 60 days. Note their FAQ promises "one or two weeks" — the legal page's 60 days governs.

Insurance — they arrange it

INSURER	AGE 0–36	OLDER
Asisa	36 €/mo	45 €/mo (37–65)
Allianz	40 €/mo (0–44)	50 €/mo (45–65)
Sanitas	53 €/mo (0–30)	—

Minimum contract three months. At Asisa's rate, 12.5 months costs about **€450**.

The award — and the one real weakness

"El estudiante tiene derecho a la obtención de un **certificado oficial de la Universidad de Extremadura** en el que se detallará el nombre del curso, el lugar de impartición, la duración y el nivel de dominio. El certificado será **de aprovechamiento** si el estudiante cumple con todos los criterios de evaluación... y será **de asistencia** si no completa las pruebas evaluativas y asiste a un porcentaje mínimo de las clases (80%)."

"The student is entitled to an official certificate of the University of Extremadura stating the course name, place of delivery, duration and level of proficiency. It will be a certificate of achievement if the student meets all assessment criteria — including a mark out of 10 — and of attendance if they do not sit the assessments but attend a minimum 80% of classes."

IELE AWARDS NO ECTS

None. León gives 20 ECTS per term, 60 for a year. If credits matter for your master's application, this is the trade-off you are making for the price.

Accommodation, holidays, living costs

IELE does **not** manage accommodation — it publishes a link list (idealista, milanuncios, erasmusu, five residences, five hostels) and recommends a Booking.com reservation as visa proof. Their own estimate of monthly living costs: room €250–300, food €150–200, utilities €50, transport €20–30, leisure €80–120 — **€500–600 a month**, which matches the independent figure of €535 for Cáceres.

2026 closures: 1–11 January · 30 March–5 April · 1 May · 29 May · **all of August** · 8 September · 12 October · 2 November · 7–8 December · 21–31 December. Office Mon–Fri 09:00–14:00; centre open 08:00–22:00. Staff speak English, Portuguese, Italian, Dutch. 2027 list not published.

THE 341 DAYS CONTAIN A TEN-WEEK TEACHING GAP

The January intake has an unpaid holiday period **30 June – 9 September 2027**. That is normal inside an academic year and does not shorten the authorisation — but know it is there, and that it is when you would work full hours.

Centro de Idiomas — Universidad de León

349 days in one submission, 60 ECTS, and a published discount for booking several terms. Double the price of Cáceres.

ADDRESS	Not published. The site gives only a map pin on the Vegazana campus — no street line in either language
EMAIL	idiomas@unileon.es
PHONE	+34 987 29 19 62
HOURS	Mon–Fri 09:00–14:30 and 16:00–19:30 (the English page says 16:30 — the two versions disagree); summer 08:30–14:30
RUN BY	FGULEM — the university's foundation, acting as its <i>medio propio</i>
LANGUAGES	Enquiries handled in English, French, Italian, Spanish

Courses and prices

COURSE	HOURS	H/WK	DATES	PRICE
Trimestral (regular)	240 (200+40)	20	Autumn: 6 Oct – 18 Dec 2026	1 term 1.400
			Winter: 7 Jan – 17 Mar 2027	2 terms 2.600
			Spring: 18 Mar – 4 Jun 2027	3 terms 3.600
Verano	220	20	28 Jun – 27 Aug 2027	2 wk 480 → 9 wk 1.575
Intensivo	40	22.5	6–17 Sep 2027 · 20 Sep–1 Oct 2027	275
Refuerzo	40	4	1 Mar – 12 May 2027	275
Online A1 prep	20	–	rolling	not publ.

Timetable 09:30–11:30, break, 12:00–14:00 — mornings. Price includes teaching, materials, an excursions package **"valorado en 200 €"**, the certificate and Wi-Fi.

THE FORM IS A GENUINE MULTI-COURSE BASKET

Five independent checkbox groups, **no radio buttons, no mutual exclusion, and no script limiting selection**: six trimesters · summer (with a weeks dropdown) · four intensives · two refuerzo · online A1. Tick any combination, press **"Calcular el importe de la matrícula"**, then one **"Inscribirse"**, one set of personal details, one visa dropdown, one payment. It is genuinely one enrolment.

The longest Q1-2027 stack: winter + spring + summer (9 wks) + both September intensives + autumn 2027 = **7 January** → **21 December 2027, 349 days**. Cost **€5,725**.

TWO CAVEATS ON THAT €5,725

The three-term rate is published with no statement that the terms must fall in one academic year, and that stack straddles 2026-27 into 2027-28. Whether the calculator applies the package rate across the boundary **can only be confirmed by running the form**. At single-term rates it would be **€6,325**. And the summer 2027 prices are carried over from the 2026 table.

Payment — instalments, with a hard consequence

- **50% within 10 days** of enrolling — this is the reservation. Non-payment cancels it.
- Balance **one month before** the course — or **four weeks** if an invitation letter was issued

- "si no pagas a tiempo, **informaremos a las autoridades** de que tu matrícula ha sido cancelada" — "if you do not pay on time, we will inform the authorities that your enrolment has been cancelled"

Visa documents

The form carries a dedicated dropdown: "**Necesita certificado para visado: Sí / No.**" The *Carta de Invitación* is issued once the reservation payment clears, and "*se expedirán, como mínimo **tres meses** antes de la fecha de inicio*" — at least three months before the start. Send: passport photo on white background, passport copy, proof of payment, medical insurance copy.

"Si hemos emitido carta de invitación, sólo podremos devolverte el importe de la reserva si la embajada te niega el visado... Importante: **Descontaremos 500 €** para cubrir los gastos administrativos."

"If we have issued an invitation letter, we can only refund the reservation amount if the embassy denies your visa... Important: **we will deduct €500** to cover administrative costs."

€500 IS THE HARSHTEST REFUSAL DEDUCTION OF THE NINE

Cáceres deducts €150 and La Rioja €150. Cancelling before an invitation letter is issued costs €200; changing dates costs €200 with three weeks' notice; **50% of any accommodation payment is non-refundable "por ningún motivo"** — for any reason whatsoever.

Levels, credits, accommodation

The form's level dropdown offers **Nulo / Inicial / Intermedio / Avanzado** — absolute beginners accepted on every date it sells. After enrolling you sit an online placement test plus a Zoom interview "*que nos permitirá confirmar la disponibilidad de un grupo adecuado a su nivel*" — a suitable group is **confirmed, not guaranteed**. Class size and minimum to run: not published.

20 ECTS per trimester, 60 for three — on 80% attendance and a mark of at least 5/10. Intensivo and refuerzo carry 3 ECTS each. Award: "*Certificado acreditativo de haber realizado el curso.*"

Host family, single room, full board, Wi-Fi and laundry: **€29/day** (€31 under 18), special diets +€3 — about **€870 a month**. University residences signposted only. **Insurance not included**; a copy of your own policy is a required enrolment document, and the secretariat can arrange cover on request at an unpublished price.

THEIR CALENDAR IS OUT OF DATE

The published PDF is headed "**CALENDARIO 2025-2026**" and its course dates are last year's, while the form sells 2027 and 2028. The only closure it marks is 24 April. The 2026-27 and 2027-28 calendars are not published.

CELE — Universidad de Zaragoza

The cheapest full year in Spain and the university's own service, not a foundation. From January it reaches 178 days.

ADDRESS	Edificio Interfacultades, 3ª planta, C/ Pedro Cerbuna 12, 50009 Zaragoza
JACA (AUGUST)	Residencia Universitaria de Jaca, C/ Universidad 3, 22700 Jaca (Huesca) · +34 974 36 01 96
EMAIL	ele@unizar.es · elever@unizar.es (Jaca/summer) · eleintensivo@unizar.es
PHONE	+34 876 55 31 36 · +34 876 55 37 31 · +34 976 76 10 47 — Mon–Fri 09:00–14:00, by appointment
RUN BY	The university itself — <i>precios públicos</i> . The cleanest legal structure of the nine
ACCREDITED	Instituto Cervantes · DELE / SIELE / CCSE exam centre · SICELE member

Courses and prices

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	H/WK	PRICE	ECTS
Curso Anual	9 Sep 2026 – 19 May 2027	770 (575+195)	20	2.230	6 UZ
Trimestral (otoño)	9 Sep – 17 Dec 2026	335	20	1.145	2,5
Cuatrimestral	11 Jan – 19 May 2027	435 (325+110)	20	1.360	3,5
Intensivo (afternoon)	11 Jan–15 Feb · 17 Feb–1 Apr · 5 Apr–10 May · 12 May–16 Jun 2027	60	8	275 ea.	1,5
Intensivo (morning, A2+)	24 May–7 Jun · 8–22 Jun · 23 Jun–7 Jul 2027	60	20	275 ea.	1,5
SIELE preparation	year-round, exams every Wednesday	60	–	275 / 450 with exam	1,5–2
DELE preparation	dates not published	45	–	250	1,5
Jaca — quincenal	3–14 Aug · 17–28 Aug 2026	65	25	285	2,5
Jaca — mensual	3–28 Aug 2026	130	25	465	5

Timetable Mon–Fri 09:00–13:00. Levels **A1 to C2**; placement test before every start. Absolute beginners accepted at every start **except** the three morning intensives from 24 May, which are A2 and above. Class maximum: not published — only *"el número de alumnos en cada clase es reducido."*

THE FORM IS A CHECKBOX BASKET

Headed **"Seleccione los cursos en los que está interesado"** — "Select the courses you are interested in" — over **twelve checkboxes**, no radio group and no limit. One submission can carry the annual or four-month block plus every intensive.

178 COURSE DAYS – AND IT CLEARS 180 COMFORTABLY

Cuatrimestral (11 Jan → 19 May) + the three morning intensives to 7 July = **11 January to 7 July 2027 = 178 days**, €2,185.

Two days short on course length — but the fifteen days after is **unconditional** under Art. 55.2, with no exception of any kind. **178 + 15 = 193**. Add the month before, which you get by filing more than two months ahead, and it is **223**.

This is the **cheapest option in Spain** that reaches a TIE from a January start — €315 less than Cáceres.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU AGAINST CÁCERES

Zaragoza's year ends **7 July 2027**; Cáceres runs to **17 December**. So €315 buys you five extra months of permit, five extra months of work rights, and a course still running when master's applications are decided. Jaca in August would extend it — separate form, Pyrenees, **2027 dates not published**.

Payment, refunds, insurance

Transfer only, Banco Santander IBAN ES15 0049 6725 47 2010009544. **Instalments on the annual course only**: €357 at enrolment, €1,873 fifteen days before the start. Everything else in full before the course. No enrolment or materials fee; the textbook is excluded. Erasmus discounts exist but are capped at "*un único curso*."

Insurance is not sold and not included — students must bring their own cover.

*"...los documentos que acrediten las circunstancias sobrevenidas que puedan justificar tal devolución (enfermedad o accidente graves y **denegación del visado**)."* ... *"la cancelación de la inscripción en cualquier curso conlleva unos gastos del **16 % sobre el importe total**... no se devolverá cantidad alguna si la cancelación no se hace con al menos **30 días naturales** de antelación."*

Visa refusal is an accepted ground for refund — but 16% of the total is retained (about €350 on a €2,185 stack), and you must cancel at least 30 days before the course starts, which is tight against a consular decision.

Visa documents — one sentence, and a condition

*"Los certificados de admisión para solicitar el visado **conllevan el pago completo del curso**."*

"Admission certificates for applying for the visa **require full payment of the course**."

That is the only statement published. There is no dedicated visa page and no other conditions.

Award and accommodation

"Certificado de aprovechamiento expedido por los Cursos de ELE de la Universidad de Zaragoza" — requires 85% attendance and passing the tests; exam fee and certificate included. In Jaca, a *certificado de asistencia* plus an optional *Diploma de Suficiencia en Lengua Española*.

Zaragoza accommodation: colegios mayores or host families via the university service — **prices not published**. **Jaca residence, full board, is fully priced**: a fortnight €517 shared / €596 single; the full month €1,133 shared / €1,305 single. Paid by card at the residence; no refund for early departure.

Holidays: not published as a list — "*los días festivos están incluidos en el calendario académico*", i.e. already netted out of the 575 contact hours. **Stale**: the *cursos específicos* and *conversación* pages still show 2025-26 dates, and the Jaca form URL still reads *jaca-2025*.

Cursos de Español — Universidad de La Rioja, Logroño

157 days from January. The only one of the nine with an explicit visa-refusal clause and insurance included in the fee.

ADDRESS	Avenida de la Paz 107, 26006 Logroño
EMAIL · PHONE	espanol@unirioja.es · 941 299 272
RUN BY	Fundación de la Universidad de La Rioja, Dpto. de Proyectos Internacionales
EXAMS	SIELE examination centre. Not Cervantes-accredited

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	H/WK	PRICE
Mensual enero	11 Jan – 5 Feb 2027	60	15	645
Trimestral invierno	11 Jan – 19 Mar 2027	195	~19	1.495
Semestral primavera	11 Jan – 16 Jun 2027	390 (300+90)	~19	2.725
Curso académico completo	5 Oct 2026 – 16 Jun 2027	585	~19	3.880
Verano — Lengua y Cultura	28 Jun – 23 Jul 2027	80	20	815

Language 09:00–12:00 Mon–Fri, culture 12:30–14:00 or 16:00–18:00. Absolute beginners accepted **5 Oct 2026 and 11 Jan 2027** — the April and May monthly courses are intermediate and above only. Class size and minimum to run: not published.

157 COURSE DAYS → 202 WITH THE PADDING

The month before plus the fifteen after take the Semestral Primavera to **202 days**, comfortably over 180. **But you need the month**, which means filing more than two months before 11 January — so by early November 2026.

NO STACKING — THE FORM IS A SINGLE-CHOICE DROPDOWN

<select name="id_curso" required> with no multiple attribute. Eleven options, and **no summer course appears in it at all**. One course per enrolment. Adding the summer course means a second, separate application: 11 Jan → 23 Jul = 194 days for €3,540.

"Denegación de visado: Si la solicitud de visado es rechazada por la Embajada/Consulado español, se devolverá el importe de la matrícula **descontando 150 € en concepto de gastos de gestión.**"

"Visa refusal: If the visa application is rejected by the Spanish Embassy/Consulate, the enrolment fee will be refunded, **deducting €150** for handling costs."

WHAT THE FEE INCLUDES — THE MOST GENEROUS OF THE NINE

Travel health insurance, teaching materials, guided city and museum visits, provincial excursions, the diploma, accommodation-search help and use of university services. It is the only centre of the nine that bundles insurance.

Award: a diploma stating level, subjects, hours and marks — explicitly usable *"como transcript para obtener créditos"*, a transcript to convert into credits **at your home university**. **No ECTS awarded** except 3 on the Erasmus course. As a Tunisian graduate not enrolled anywhere else, that means no credits at all.

Accommodation: host family, full board, **€800/month + €50** management fee. One month minimum, then renewable; ten days' notice to leave. **Optional SIELE certificate €155**, free on the summer course. Cancellation otherwise: 50% back at

30+ days, 20% at 7–30 days, nothing inside a week. One date change allowed, €50.

STALE

Summer literature page still shows 2026 dates; both summer enrolment links say "antes del 21 de junio del 2026"; the normativa and visa pages were last modified 26 July 2024.

Cursos Internacionales — USC, Santiago de Compostela

147 days maximum from January, and it cannot be extended by booking. Insurance included; beginners restricted to one date.

ADDRESS	Avda. das Ciencias s/n, chalet 2, Campus Vida, 15782 Santiago de Compostela
EMAIL · PHONE	cursos.internacionales@usc.es · +34 881 814 423
RUN BY	Cursos Internacionais da USC, S.L. — CIF B15544554, a company

BLOCK	START DATES	WEEKS	H/WK	PRICE
Spring	7 Jan · 10 Feb · 1 Mar · 3 May 2027	2–21	20	377 → 2.691
Autumn	28 Sep · 2 Nov 2026	2–12	20	337 → 1.591
Summer	14 Sep 2026	2–16	20	451 → 2.296
Hispanic Studies Semester	January (deadline 1 Nov)	13	–	2.150 + extras

Pre-enrolment fee €230 on top of the Spring price. Mornings 09:15–14:00 — 3 h language plus 1 h workshop. Levels A1–C2, placement test on day one. **Class maximum 15**, the only one of the nine to publish a cap.

~147 COURSE DAYS → ~192 WITH THE PADDING

Twenty-one weeks from 7 January plus the full 45 days reaches about **192 days** — over 180, but with only twelve days to spare, on an end date USC does not publish. Thinner margin than any other option here.

THE END DATE IS NOT PUBLISHED, AND AUTUMN 2027 DOES NOT EXIST YET

Both the English and Spanish pages give only the four start dates — **no end date in either language**. Twenty-one weeks from 7 January runs to roughly **2–4 June 2027**, which is a derivation, not their figure. The Autumn page still shows only 2026 intakes, so there is no 2027 autumn product to add at booking. Their only extension route is a conversation: *"If you wish to extend the course period and stay longer, just let us know."*

Their booking system sits behind a login, so unlike the other eight I could not inspect what combinations it allows.

"Visa refusals: If the course has started, there is no refund. The student has to prove Visa refusal with an official document and a **fee of 200 €** will be charged. If no official document is presented, there is no refund."

Refund minus €200, and only before the course starts.

Beginners: accepted across all four Spring starts — but note that in Autumn *"Beginner students start on September 28th"* only. **Insurance included** in the fee. Award: *"Diploma + 1 Transcript + ECTS credits"* — **the number of ECTS is not published**. No visa document is named anywhere on the site, which is a real gap against Cáceres and León.

Accommodation: family full board **€39/night**, half board €34; flat single room **€18/night** with utilities and Wi-Fi; residence €27/night single, June–August only. Payment and accommodation costs due 15 days before the start; no instalment plan. Under-18s not admitted to Spring. Closure calendar not published.

Casa de las Lenguas — Universidad de Oviedo

124 days from January at €1,625. Real package discounts — but they only work from an October start, and there is no refund if the visa fails.

ADDRESS Campus de Humanidades "El Milán", C/ Francisco Rodríguez García s/n, 33011 Oviedo
 THREE VARIANTS PUBLISHED

EMAIL · PHONE clenguas@uniovi.es · clenguas2@uniovi.es (enrolment) · +34 985 10 96 64 / 66

RUN BY The university itself — CIF Q3318001I

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	PRICE
Lengua y Cultura — Trimestral	5 Oct – 18 Dec 2026	295	1.395
Lengua y Cultura — Semestral	11 Jan – 14 May 2027	375	1.625
Semestral Reducido	11 Jan – 19 Mar 2027	not publ.	850
Curso Anual (both above)	Oct 2026 – May 2027	670	~2.494 DERIVED
Español Inicial Semestral (beginners)	11 Jan – 14 May 2027	260	1.224
Intensivo Mayo-Junio	24 May – 25 Jun 2027	150	1.200
Intensivo de Julio	5 – 30 Jul 2027	120	960 / 741 if stacked
Intensivo de Agosto	2 – 27 Aug 2027	120	960 / 741 if stacked

TWO GENUINE PACKAGE DISCOUNTS — THE ONLY CENTRE WITH THEM

"Deducción por matrícula conjunta en los cursos Trimestral + Semestral: **526 €**" and "Deducción por matrícula en un segundo o tercer curso intensivo general de verano: **219 €**". But the first requires an **October** start, and the €526 deduction does not bridge spring into summer.

124 DAYS, AND IT CANNOT REACH 180 EVEN FULLY PADDED

11 January to 14 May is 124 days. With the whole 45 days that is **169** — eleven short. Oviedo's January semester cannot produce a TIE by any route, and their summer courses are on a separate form.

NO REFUND IF THE VISA IS REFUSED

"solamente procederá la devolución... cuando, **por causas no imputables al sujeto pasivo**, el servicio no se preste por la Universidad" — "a refund shall only be due when, for reasons not attributable to the taxpayer, the service is not provided by the University." A visa refusal is attributable to you. And: "No se devolverá el dinero si es el alumno quien decide cancelar la matrícula."

No visa page and no admission letter is described anywhere on the site. The full sitemap was checked.

Stacking: academic and summer courses are two separate *boletines* emailed as Word files. The academic one does allow ticking Trimestral + Semestral + "Curso Anual". Spring plus summer would be two enrolments, and there is a **nine-day teaching gap, 15–23 May**. Two enrolments reach 11 Jan → 27 Aug = 229 days for €4,307.

Beginners: a dedicated *Español Inicial* course starting 5 Oct 2026 and **11 Jan 2027**; also A1 in July and August, but **not** in the May–June intensive. Levels A1–C1. Class size not published. **ECTS: none published** — Oviedo gives hours only. Award: *Certificado de Aprovechamiento* at 80% attendance plus the final exam, otherwise a *Certificado de Asistencia*.

Insurance not sold, and a copy of your own policy is required at enrolment. Payment by transfer only, single payment, **30 days before the start** — though the *boletín* says 15 days, and the two published deadlines conflict. Host family full

board: **price not published**, quote by email.

EVERY 2027 PRICE IS PROVISIONAL

The tariff PDF is headed "*Calendario y tarifas **pendientes de aprobación** en el periodo 1-1-2027 a 31-8-2027*", and each course page repeats "TASA PENDIENTE DE APROBACIÓN". The August page still shows €900 and 2026 dates against the tariff's €960 and 2027 dates.

Servicio de Idiomas — Universidad de Murcia

Cervantes-accredited, the university's own service, and cheap — but no January start, nothing over 120 days, and no refund.

ADDRESS Edificio Rector Soler, 2ª planta, Campus de Espinardo, 30071 Murcia
 EMAIL · PHONE spanishcourses@um.es · idiomas.info@um.es · +34 868 88 3868
 RUN BY The university itself · Instituto Cervantes accredited centre

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	H/WK	PRICE	ECTS
Lengua y Cultura Hispánicas	Sep–Dec · Feb–May	300	~18	1.575	n/p
Cuatrimstral de español	Sep–Dec · Feb–May	75	4	300	3
Intensivo	September · January	30	15	120	1
Individual workshops (6)	as above	15–30	–	350 each	n/p

THEIR OWN SITE GIVES TWO DIFFERENT PRICES FOR THE SAME COURSE

The administrative page says **€1,575 for 300 hours**. A marketing microsite says **€2,880–3,380 for 315 hours**. Every file on that microsite dates from **September 2022** and its catalogue PDF is literally named "220908 CATALOGO BORRADOR-3.pdf" — a draft. **Treat €1,575 as current** and confirm before paying.

NO REFUND, IN ANY CIRCUMSTANCE

"De acuerdo con la Ley de Tasas y Precios Públicos **no se devolverá el importe pagado** en el curso o actividad (aunque se trate de una causa de fuerza mayor) con una única excepción: que el curso no se realice." — "the amount paid will not be refunded (even in a case of force majeure), with a single exception: that the course does not take place."

No >180-day product exists, and the enrolment system uses one opaque activity hash per course — each of the six workshops is a separate inscription. Level test costs **€5**, provisional certificate €3. **Three calendar days to pay** after enrolling or the place is lost. Groups of 10 to 20; under 10, the course may be cancelled. Award: a diploma stating level, hours and mark, at 80% attendance. Accommodation via VIMUR, the university's matching platform — no prices published, and its public page still carries a maintenance notice dated **January 2012**.

Visa documents: "Visa information" is listed as an optional service. No admission letter or enrolment certificate is named. Not published.

Centro Internacional del Español — Universidad de Burgos

The only course in Spain that states in writing that it meets the study-visa requirements. 310 days for €3,000 — and enrolment closed in July 2026.

ADDRESS	Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Empresariales, Despacho 75, 09001 Burgos
EMAIL · PHONE	incourses@ubu.es · +34 647 55 17 60 – by appointment, mornings 09:00–14:00
RUN BY	UBU centre created 14 May 2019 (BOCYL 30/05/2019); shop operated by Fundación General UBU, CIF G09343500

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	PRICE	STATUS
Curso intensivo anual: acceso a la universidad	19 Aug 2026 → 24 Jun 2027	~620	3.000	CLOSED 17 JUL 2026
Curso regular — 1er semestre	16–17 Sep → Dec 2026	50	160 / 210	open to 8 Sep
Curso regular — 2º semestre	Feb → May 2027	50	160 / 210	2027 NOT YET PUBLISHED
Curso Intensivo Enero	18 Jan → 1 Feb 2027	40	150 / 190	OPEN TO 11 JAN
Curso julio — 3 semanas	6 – 24 July	60	400	closed
Español en la Tierra del Vino	June	12 + visits	350	to end April
Spanish One to One	student chooses	à la carte	25 €/hour	open

"El Curso Anual de Español **cumple los requisitos establecidos para la solicitud del visado por estudios de Lengua Española**. No obstante, la concesión o denegación del visado es competencia exclusiva de la Embajada o el Consulado..."

"The Annual Spanish Course **meets the requirements established for applying for a study visa** for Spanish Language. However, granting or refusing the visa is the exclusive competence of the Embassy or Consulate..."

EVERYTHING ABOUT THIS PRODUCT IS BUILT FOR A VISA APPLICANT

310 days in one indivisible enrolment. Every enrolment form carries a built-in field: "*¿Necesita carta de Admisión para solicitar un visado?*" — "Do you need a letter of admission to apply for a visa?" The price includes materials, cultural activities, the level test, the diploma, university services and **an accommodation-finding service**. Levels **A1 to C2**, beginners accepted. Class of 5 to 12.

Refund on refusal: full, **minus a €400 retention**. And they arrange the housing themselves — "*nosotros te tramitamos la reserva, pago al llegar*" — with a published rate of **€33/day** single room.

AND THE WINDOW CLOSED ON 17 JULY 2026

The next opens around **late April 2027**, for the course starting **August 2027**. All that is bookable for January is the 15-day intensive at €150.

Keep this one. If January 2027 proves difficult, Burgos in August 2027 is a cleaner product than anything else on this list.

Note: the regular semester courses **start at A2** — a true beginner cannot enter them. Single payment by transfer to CaixaBank IBAN ES12 2100 9168 6122 0005 6722, at least a week before the course. Award: "*certificado oficial de la Universidad de Burgos*"; **6 ECTS** for the 50-hour course, 5 for the 40-hour intensive. General cancellation: 10% at 15 days' notice, 40% at 5–15 days, nothing after.

STALE

The B1/B2 accreditation page lists a 2022 calendar; "¿Cómo venir a Burgos?" last updated November 2021; the online shop's product URLs still read regular-course-a2-autumn-2020. Real enrolment happens through the ubu.es webforms, not the shop.

Centro de Lenguas — Universidad de Almería

A good annual course at a good price on the Mediterranean — and unusable for you on three separate counts.

ADDRESS Ctra. Sacramento s/n, 04120 La Cañada de San Urbano, Almería
 EMAIL · PHONE clenguas@fundacionual.es · +34 950 01 52 85
 RUN BY Fundación UAL. **Not** Cervantes-accredited — it is an **exam** centre, which is different

COURSE	DATES	HOURS	H/WK	PRICE	ECTS
Lengua y Cultura Españolas (annual)	1 Oct 2026 → 12 Jun 2027	600	20	2.700	60
Lengua y Cultura — 1er cuatrimestre	1 Oct 2026 → 10 Feb 2027	300	20	1.500	30
Español A1–C1, mañanas	1 Oct 2026 → 8 Feb 2027	90	6	450	9
Español A1–C1, tarde	1 Oct 2026 → 17 Dec 2026	44	4	220	5

WHY IT DOES NOT WORK

- 1. Nothing starts in the first half of the year.** All twelve published Spanish courses begin 1 October 2026. There is no second-semester course and **no summer course** — the summer page exists but returns zero results.
- 2. Enrolment closed 20 September 2026.**
- 3. No refund if your visa is refused** — see below. And no visa document of any kind is described anywhere on the site.

"No se considerará causa justificada para la baja de su matrícula y devolución de precios la denegación del visado o similar." ... "En los casos de denegación del visado... no procede la devolución de precios, ni será posible transferir el importe a otra persona."

"Visa refusal or similar shall not be considered justified cause for withdrawing your enrolment and refunding fees." ... "In cases of visa refusal, **no refund is due**, nor may the amount be transferred to another person."

The one concession: the amount may be applied to another course **within the same academic year**.

For completeness: the annual course is genuinely good — 600 hours at 20 h/week, 60 ECTS, two instalments, and 255 days. Beginners accepted, no admission requirements. Class of 7 to 16. Award: *certificado de aprovechamiento* with ECTS at 80% attendance plus the exam. Discounts of 10–20% for early enrolment. Accommodation not offered.

THE SITE CONTRADICTS ITSELF BADLY

Their FAQ quotes an entirely different price structure — "ANNUAL 120 hours, €600" — against the live catalogue's 600 hours at €2,700, and links to dead URLs. The discount policy PDF is headed "**CURSO 2017-18**". The live booking data is the reliable source; the public pages are not.

The nine, compared

Everything that matters, on one page

UNIVERSITY	JAN 2027 PRICE	DAYS	H/WK	ECTS	REFUND IF REFUSED	VISA DOCUMENT	LIVING €/MO
Cáceres — IELE	2.500	341	20	none	−€150 BEST	Offer + Admission letter	535
León	5.725	349	20	60	−€500 WORST	Carta de Invitación	580
Zaragoza	2.185	178	20	3,5–8	−16%, 30-day notice	Certificado de admisión	630
La Rioja	2.725	157	~19	none	−€150 EXPLICIT	not published	625
Santiago — USC	2.921	~147	20	n/p	−€200	not published	570
Oviedo	1.625	124	n/p	none	none	not published	640
Murcia	1.575	~120	~18	n/p	none	not published	590
Burgos	150	15	20	5	−€400	Carta de Admisión	635
Almería	—	—	20	60	none	not published	590

Which will sell you a long enrolment, and how

UNIVERSITY	BOOKING SYSTEM	CAN YOU STACK?
León	Five checkbox groups, one submit, one payment	Yes — genuinely, with a published discount
Zaragoza	Twelve checkboxes, no limit	Yes — but the courses run out at 7 July
Oviedo	Word <i>boletín</i> emailed; two separate forms	Partly — academic terms yes, summer no
Cáceres	Ticket list with no dates at all	Not needed — one product already spans the year
La Rioja	Single-choice dropdown, no summer option in it	No
Murcia	One activity hash per course	No
Almería	Hidden single CodCurso field; every course flagged "paquete": 0	No — no bundle products exist in the system
Burgos	Single-select "Escoja una opción"	No
Santiago	Login-gated — could not be inspected	Unknown

Which reach a TIE, once the padding is counted

UNIVERSITY	COURSE DAYS	+15 ONLY	+45	VERDICT	COST
Cáceres	341	—	—	✓ on course length alone	2.500
León 3 terms	349	—	—	✓ on course length alone	5.725
Zaragoza stacked	178	193	223	✓ on the 15 days alone	2.185
La Rioja	157	172	202	✓ needs the month — file early	2.725
León 2 terms	149	164	194	✓ needs the month	2.600
Santiago	~147	162	~ 192	✓ needs the month; thin margin	2.921
Oviedo	124	139	169	✗ short by 11 even fully padded	1.625
Murcia	~120	135	165	✗	1.575
Burgos (Jan)	15	30	60	✗	150
Almería	—	—	—	✗ nothing starts in Q1	—

Six of the nine reach a TIE from a January start, not two. That is the difference the padding makes, and the earlier version of this document had it wrong.

Cáceres — €2,500 — 11 January 2027

Zaragoza is now genuinely cheaper at **€2,185**, and clears 180 days on the unconditional fifteen alone. So the choice is real. What €315 buys at Cáceres is **five more months**: its year runs to 17 December 2027, Zaragoza's ends 7 July.

Those five months are when you would be working 30 hours a week, and when master's applications for September 2028 are decided. Cáceres also clears 180 **on course length alone**, so nothing rests on the padding, on filing early, or on stacking. And it is in the cheapest city in Spain.

Its two real weaknesses stand: **no ECTS at all**, and a booking system that records no dates.

Before you commit — three emails

TO	ASK
seciele@unex.es Cáceres	Confirm 11 or 18 January , and the end date. Confirm the enrolment certificate will state the full period, total hours and weekly hours. Ask whether the year can be certified as a curso preparatorio for a UEx master's.
idiomas@unileon.es León	Does the three-term package rate apply across the 2026-27 / 2027-28 boundary ? That is the difference between €5,725 and €6,325. And what are the 2027 summer prices?
ele@unizar.es cc elever@unizar.es	Can the January block plus intensives plus Jaca in August go on one enrolment? What are Jaca's 2027 dates? That is what turns 178 days into roughly 229.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT DOES NOT SETTLE

USC's Spring end date — genuinely unpublished in both languages; the ~2 June figure is derived, not theirs.

USC's booking system — behind a login, so its combinations could not be checked.

León's package rate across academic years — only a form submission can confirm it.

Murcia's price — €1,575 and €2,880 both appear on their own site.

Oviedo's 2027 prices — all marked *pendiente de aprobación*.

Jaca's August 2027 dates — not published.

Whether a <180-day permit is workable for employment — legally yes (the visa accredits the situation under Art. 208; no official source requires a TIE to be hired), but no first-hand account of anyone doing it exists, and the NIE is hard to evidence without a card.